ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — SOCIAL SCIENCE · CLASS 9 · SET 03

Max. Marks: 80 · The Mastermind Coaching Classes, Jaipur · Alternate correct methods to be given full credit

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions — 20 questions · 20 marks

Select the most appropriate option. (20 × 1 = 20)

1. The Gulf Stream, which keeps the waters near Norway relatively warm despite their high latitude, is a:

(a) cold current (b) tidal current
(c) warm current (d) stationary current

> **Ans: (c)** The cold Labrador Current, by contrast, supports sea-ice formation off Canada.

2. The most abundant gas in dry air of the Earth's atmosphere is:

(a) oxygen (b) carbon dioxide (c) nitrogen (d) argon

> **Ans: (c)** Nitrogen ≈ 78%, oxygen ≈ 21%.

3. The Vijayanagara Empire was established in 1336 by:

(a) Harihara and Bukkā (b) Kṛiṣhṇadevarāya and Achyutadevarāya
(c) Kumāra Kampana and Muthu Vīrappa (d) Rāṇā Kumbhā and Rāṇā Sāngā

> **Ans: (a)** Capital near present-day Hampi.

4. **Assertion (A):** Fake news can weaken a democracy.
Reason (R): It misleads citizens and affects the informed choices they make while voting.

> **Ans: (a)** R explains how fake news harms democratic decisions.

5. Which of the following is an indirect tax?

(a) Personal income tax (b) Corporate income tax
(c) Tax on a salary slab (d) Goods and Services Tax (GST)

> **Ans: (d)** Indirect taxes are added to the price of goods and services.

6. Match Column I with Column II and choose the correct option.

Column I	Column II
(a) Sumer	1. Yellow River (Huang He) valley
(b) Egypt	2. Cuneiform
(c) China	3. Hieroglyphs

(a) a-2, b-3, c-1 (b) a-3, b-2, c-1 (c) a-1, b-2, c-3 (d) a-2, b-1, c-3

> **Ans: (a)** Sumer – cuneiform; Egypt – hieroglyphs; China – Huang He.

7. The Nattukottai Chettiars of Tamil Nadu are known in Indian history as:

(a) warrior chiefs of the Deccan
(b) traders and bankers who worked across Sri Lanka, Burma and Malaya
(c) temple architects of Hampi
(d) tribal forest guardians

> **Ans: (b)** They reinvested profits in trade, temples and education.

8. Which of the following will shift the demand curve for tea to the right?

(a) a rise in the price of tea itself
(b) a rise in the price of coffee, a substitute

(c) a fall in the population
(d) a fall in the price of sugar only

Ans: (b) Substitute's price rise increases demand for tea.

9. The Bishnoi movement, in which Amrita Devi gave her life to protect trees, took place in:

(a) Uttarakhand (b) Assam (c) Rajasthan (d) Keralam

Ans: (c) It later influenced the Chipko movement.

10. Read the statements and choose the correct option.
Statement 1: Weathering is the breaking down of rocks without much movement of the material.
Statement 2: Deposition is the process in which rocks are broken down into smaller pieces.

(a) Both statements are correct
(b) Statement 1 is correct, Statement 2 is incorrect
(c) Statement 1 is incorrect, Statement 2 is correct
(d) Both statements are incorrect

Ans: (b) Deposition is the laying down of material by agents; breaking down is weathering.

11. National Good Governance Day is observed every year on:

(a) 25 December (b) 26 January (c) 15 August (d) 2 October

Ans: (a) Celebrated to promote good governance.

12. The Rajya Sabha members are elected through:

(a) First-Past-the-Post
(b) direct election by all adults
(c) nomination by the Prime Minister
(d) proportional representation by the single transferable vote

Ans: (d) Also used for the President and Vice-President.

13. Cyclones in the North Indian Ocean are named in sequence from a list of 169 names given by _____ member countries, including India.

(a) 5 (b) 25 (c) 50 (d) 13

Ans: (d) E.g., Biparjoy (2023), Remal (2024).

14. The emperor who adopted the policy of Dhamma after the Kalinga war was:

(a) Chandragupta Maurya (b) Aśhoka
(c) Samudragupta (d) Harshavardhana

Ans: (b) Mauryan emperor, grandson of Chandragupta.

15. A business sells discounts, runs social media campaigns and designs packaging. These activities belong to the functional area of:

(a) finance and accounting (b) human resources
(c) marketing and sales (d) operations

Ans: (c) Promotion and customer attraction.

16. The Economic Survey of India is presented in Parliament:

(a) just before the Union Budget (b) after the Union Budget
(c) only in an election year (d) in August every year

Ans: (a) Annual document of the Ministry of Finance.

17. The principle of compounding means that returns are earned on:

(a) the original investment only

(b) both the original investment and the returns already earned
(c) inflation only
(d) the tax paid

> **Ans: (b)** Starting early gives more time for compounding.

18. The Mesolithic period is best known for:

(a) use of iron
(b) cuneiform writing
(c) planned cities
(d) small stone tools called microliths

> **Ans: (d)** Hunters-gatherers using microliths, with fishing.

19. The Emergency in India was declared in the year:

(a) 1975 (b) 1950 (c) 1962 (d) 1991

> **Ans: (a)** It tested democracy; democracy recovered through elections in 1977.

20. At the Battle of Talikota (1565), the Vijayanagara army was defeated by:

(a) the Mughals under Bābur
(b) the Marathas under Śhivājī
(c) an alliance of the Deccan sultanates
(d) the Ahoms

> **Ans: (c)** The city was sacked and the empire fragmented.

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Type — 4 questions · 8 marks

Each question carries 2 marks. Answer in about 40 words. (4 × 2 = 8)

21. What is scarcity? Why does scarcity force people to make choices?

> Scarcity = resources are limited relative to wants (1). Since all wants cannot be satisfied, we must choose among alternatives, giving up some (1).

22. Differentiate between ‘government’ and ‘governance’ with one example.

> Government = institutions with authority to exercise power/provide services (1). Governance = process of making, implementing and monitoring decisions, e.g., planning, maintaining and getting feedback on street lighting by the panchayat (1).

23. What is meant by ‘innocent passage’? Does it allow foreign ships to fish in a country's territorial waters?

> Right of foreign ships to pass through territorial waters if they do not threaten peace, order or security (1). No – fishing and military activity are not allowed (1).

O R

What are fishing grounds? Why do they form where warm and cold currents meet?

> Regions of rich fish catch (1). Meeting currents mix waters and bring nutrients, supporting plankton and fish (1).

24. State any two reasons why regular elections are important in a democracy.

> Any two (1 each): citizens choose representatives; government made accountable; peaceful change of government; gives legitimacy.

SECTION C — Short Answer Type — 5 questions · 15 marks

Each question carries 3 marks. Answer in about 60 words. (5 × 3 = 15)

25. Why did the early civilisations of Mesopotamia, Egypt and China arise in river valleys? Give three reasons.

> Fertile alluvial soil (1); water for irrigation, drinking and transport (1); surplus supported cities, trade, specialised work and writing (1).

26. Mohan Singh Oberoi began as a hotel desk clerk on ₹50 a month. List three entrepreneurial qualities he showed.

> Any three (1 each): willingness to learn every aspect of work; courage to take risks (mortgaged his wife's jewellery to buy a hotel in 1934); hard work and dedication; focus on customer satisfaction; planning and management.

27. Why is India's climate called ‘tropical monsoon’? State three features of the monsoon.

> Monsoon – seasonal reversal of winds (1); south-west monsoon brings most rain in June–September (1); distinct seasons – winter, pre-monsoon, monsoon, post-monsoon (1).

OR

Explain three ways in which individuals and governments can reduce their carbon footprint.

> Any three (1 each): use renewable energy; save electricity; public transport; plant trees; reduce waste; stricter emission norms.

28. Aman invests ₹10,000 at 10% per year. Calculate the amount after two years under (a) simple interest and (b) compound interest. What does the difference show?

> (a) SI: 10,000 + 2,000 = ₹12,000 (1). (b) CI: year 1 = ₹11,000; year 2 = ₹12,100 (1). Difference ₹100 shows interest earned on interest – compounding (1).

29. Write any three Fundamental Rights and one duty of the State in protecting them.

> Any three (½ each): equality, freedom, against exploitation, freedom of religion, cultural and educational rights, constitutional remedies (1.5). Duty: not to violate them and to protect citizens' rights through courts/laws (1.5).

SECTION D — Long Answer Type — 4 questions · 20 marks

Each question carries 5 marks. Answer in about 120 words. (4 × 5 = 20)

30. What are the factors that shift demand and supply? Explain any three of each with examples.

> Demand: income, prices of related goods, tastes, population, season/expectations (any three, 1.5). Supply: price of inputs, technology, number of sellers, related goods, expectations (any three, 1.5); examples (1) + clarity of shifts (1).

OR

‘Excessive government control and unregulated markets are both problematic.’ Explain with reference to the roles of government in the market.

> Government regulates unfair practices (1); checks monopolies (1); sets price ceilings/floors (1); provides public goods (1); excessive control causes shortages/distortions while no regulation hurts consumers (1).

31. Explain the maritime zones of a coastal country with the help of a labelled sketch. Why are they important?

> Sketch with baseline, territorial waters 12 nm, contiguous zone 24 nm, EEZ 200 nm, high seas (2.5). Rights in each (1.5). Importance: resources, fishing, security, trade, law (1).

OR

‘India's coasts are vulnerable to cyclones and tsunamis.’ Describe the early warning systems and government projects that protect coastal communities.

> 2004 tsunami (about 2,30,000 lives; Tamil Nadu, Andaman & Nicobar etc.) (1); ITEWC with ocean-bottom pressure recorders, tide gauges (1); cyclone warning services and storm-surge warning by INCOIS–IMD (1); NCRMP – shelters, DSS (1); GEMINI device for fishermen under PMMSY (1).

32. Describe the work of rivers in the form of erosion, transport and deposition with landforms in the upper, middle and lower courses.

Upper: V-valley, waterfall, gorge (1.5); middle: meanders, flood plain (1.5); lower: ox-bow lake, levee, delta (1.5); erosion, transport, deposition defined (0.5).

OR

Explain how landslides, avalanches and dust storms threaten life, and how people can prepare for them.

Meaning/cause of each hazard (2); effects on settlement, roads, farming (1.5); preparedness: warning, afforestation, terracing, bunding, shelters (1.5).

33. What is good governance? Explain its features and the roles of the government, citizens, media and civil society in achieving it.

Good governance – transparent, accountable, effective, responsive, participatory, rule of law (2). Government – laws and services (0.75); citizens – vote, follow law, participate (0.75); media – informs (0.75); civil society – awareness (0.75).

OR

Explain the Indian ideal of Rām Rājya and Rājadharma and how they influence modern ideas of public policy.

Rām Rājya – probity, transparency, compassion, welfare, people-centric (2); Rājadharma – protect people and uphold dharma (1.5); 'Prajāsukhe sukhaṁ rājñaḥ' (1); mottos like Satyameva Jayate in institutions (0.5).

SECTION E — Source-based / Case-based Questions — 3 questions · 12 marks

Each question carries 4 marks (1 + 1 + 2). (3 × 4 = 12)

34. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.*
"Heavy rain on a deforested slope loosened the soil and rocks. A large mass moved downhill, burying part of a road and cutting off a hill village. Rescue teams cleared the path, and the local administration later built retaining walls and planted trees to hold the soil."

(i) Name the natural hazard described.

Landslide.

(ii) Identify one human activity that increased the risk.

Deforestation (removal of vegetation).

(iii) Suggest two preventive measures from the passage and explain how they help.

Retaining walls hold the slope (1); planting trees binds soil with roots (1).

35. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.*
"Local tradition says the Mughal emperor used to send a royal slipper to rulers as a symbol of his supremacy. Rulers were expected to receive it ceremonially at the border and pay tribute. When it reached Madurai, Muthu Vīrappa Nāyak refused to meet the procession at the border, forced the messengers to carry it to the palace hall and had them expelled."

(i) Which ruler is mentioned in the passage?

Muthu Vīrappa Nāyak (III) of Madurai.

(ii) What did the slipper symbolise?

Imperial supremacy / subordination.

(iii) Explain how this incident is an example of resistance without war.

He refused the ceremonial protocol of subordination (1); defied Mughal authority through symbolic acts instead of battle (1).

36. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.*
"A factory can use its machines for two goods only: laptops and phones. Its possible combinations are A: 60 laptops, 0 phones; B: 50 laptops, 20 phones; C: 30 laptops, 40 phones; D: 0 laptops, 60 phones."

(i) What is the name of the curve drawn by joining these combinations?

> Production Possibility Curve (PPC).

(ii) What is the opportunity cost of producing 20 phones when moving from A to B?

> 10 laptops.

(iii) Moving from B to C, the factory gives up 20 laptops for 20 phones. Why is the opportunity cost increasing? What would a point inside the curve indicate?

> Resources are not equally suitable for both goods, so more of one good costs more of the other (1). Inside – resources under-used/inefficient (1).

SECTION F — Map-based Question — 1 questions · 5 marks

(1 × 5 = 5)

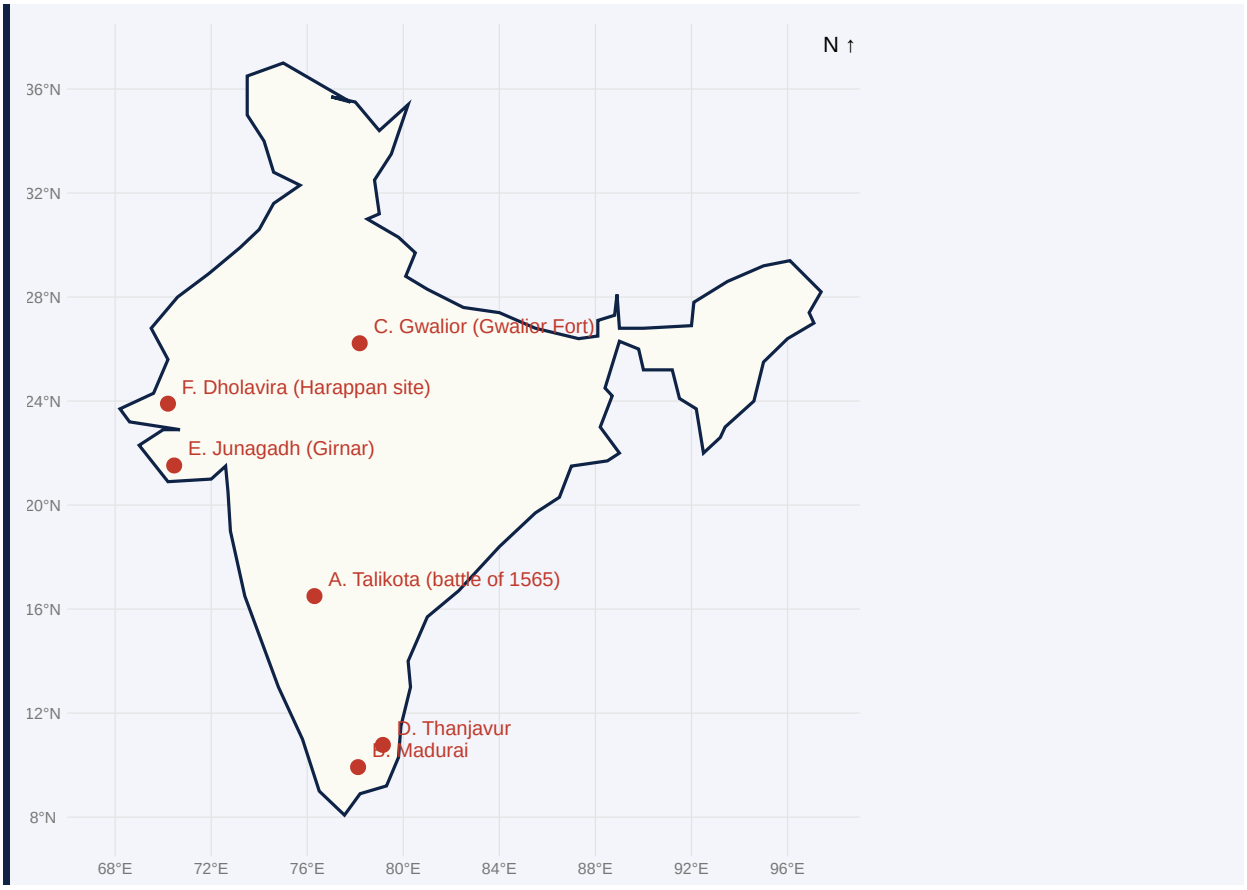
37. On the outline map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following (use the given letter/number for each): *Attempt any five. Each item carries 1 mark.*

A. Talikota (battle of 1565)
B. Madurai
C. Gwalior (Gwalior Fort)
D. Thanjavur
E. Junagadh (Girnar)
F. Dholavira (Harappan site)

Note — in lieu of Q.37, for visually impaired candidates only (answer any five):

1. Name the State/UT in which Talikota is located.
2. Name the State/UT in which Madurai is located.
3. Name the State/UT in which Gwalior is located.
4. Name the State/UT in which Thanjavur is located.
5. Name the State/UT in which Junagadh is located.
6. Name the State/UT in which Dholavira is located.

> 1 mark for each correctly located and labelled item (any five). Correct positions are shown below; answers marked within a tolerance of about 150 km are acceptable.


N ↑
36°N
32°N
28°N
24°N
20°N
16°N
12°N
8°N
68°E
72°E
76°E
80°E
84°E
88°E
92°E
96°E
C. Gwalior (Gwalior Fort)
F. Dholavira (Harappan site)
E. Junagadh (Girnar)
A. Talikota (battle of 1565)
D. Thanjavur
B. Madurai